Project Proposal Guidelines

The proposal establishes the initial direction of your project. It should explain what your group intends to investigate or create, why the topic is worthwhile, and how you plan to develop it within the available timeframe.

Your proposal should address the following:

The Topic and Objective

Define the central question or purpose of the project. Provide enough context for a reader to understand its significance.

The Initial Background

Identify relevant sources, algorithms, or existing work, and explain how they inform your proposed direction.

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The Format and Intended Outcomes

State the project format, describe what you intend to produce, and explain what the completed work should demonstrate.

The Scope and Approach

Identify the main ideas or methods you expect to explore. Distinguish the core work you intend to complete from possible extensions.

Plan

Outline the main stages of the project, how your group will organise the work, and any anticipated difficulties or questions requiring guidance. At this stage, the emphasis is on a well-defined objective, including any evidence of initial understanding and a realistic plan for the timeframe of the project. You should ideally have engaged with the background material enough to explain why your proposed approach is reasonable.

Use your early mentor consultations to discuss the scope and feasibility of your idea. The proposal provides a starting point for the project, and your direction may develop as you learn more. Discuss substantial changes with your mentor and record the reasons in your project notebook.